virtual machine A is running and has an associated Elastic IP. The following steps let you replace the virtual machine with a new one without changing the public IP address:

1. Start a new virtual machine B to replace the running virtual machine A.
2. Install and start applications as well as all dependencies on virtual machine B.
3. Disassociate the Elastic IP from virtual machine A, and associate it with virtual machine B.

Requests using the Elastic IP address will now be routed to virtual machine B, with a short interruption while moving the Elastic IP. You can also connect multiple public IP addresses with a virtual machine by using multiple network interfaces, as described in the next section. This method can be useful if you need to host different applications running on the same port, or if you want to use a unique fixed public IP address for different websites.

WARNING IPv4 addresses are scarce. To prevent stockpiling Elastic IP addresses, AWS will charge you for Elastic IP addresses that aren’t associated with a virtual machine. You’ll clean up the allocated IP address at the end of the next section.

3.7 Adding an additional network interface to a virtual machine

In addition to managing public IP addresses, you can control your virtual machine’s network interfaces. It is possible to add multiple network interfaces to a VM and control the private and public IP addresses associated with those network interfaces. Here are some typical use cases for EC2 instances with multiple network interfaces: